mainstream black community." "Black Americans," Gosse concludes, "felt a strong solidarity with the colonial world, and quite easily recognize a colonial situation and the reality of national liberation." "No one knows the master as well as the servant," Malcolm X explained upon his highly photographed meeting with Fidel.[20]

Manning Marable concurs. "No white political leader," he wrote in 2000, "would ever come as close to receiving this kind of approval from literally every sector of the African American community … Only Nelson Mandela of South Africa surpassed the moral authority and political credibility that Castro could claim within black America."[21]

When Fidel Castro returned to Harlem in 1995 – 35 years after his historic 1960 appearance at the United Nations, when he spurned the upscale hotel assigned to his entourage and lodged instead at Harlem's Hotel Theresa – he was greeted at the Abyssinian Baptist Church by yet another generation of black and Latino leaders: U.S. Congress members Charles Rangel, José Serrano, and Nydia Velásquez, religious leaders Conrad Muhammad and Calvin O. Butts, and scholars and authors Angela Davis, Leonard Jeffries, and John Henrik Clarke, as well as an audience of 1,300 people.[22]

Cuba in Africa and Latin America

In an era of Cold War and superpower politics, Cuba became an important player on its own. The small country took an active role in the Non-Aligned Movement of mostly Third World countries that strove to develop an international voice for former colonies in Africa, Asia, and Latin America outside of the East–West dynamic. As relations with the United State deteriorated, Cuba also became an early challenger to some international institutions under U.S. control, like the World Bank and the newly founded Inter-American Development Bank. Although the United States successfully pushed for Cuba's expulsion from the Organization of American States in 1962, many Latin American countries opposed the move. "La OEA es cosa de risa," sang Carlos Puebla in a popular tune of the day. "How can I not laugh at the OAS?"